The Missing Duck Mystery

5-Minute Reader's Theater Script

Easy Vocabulary Edition

Cast: 5 Readers **Duration:** ~5 Minutes **Target:** Beginner–Intermediate English **Lines:** 36

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Cast of Characters

Reader	Character	Description
Reader 1	Narrator	Tells the story and sets each scene
Reader 2	Mia	A calm, clever student detective
Reader 3	Ben	Mia's nervous best friend
Reader 4	Coach Lee	The basketball coach, proud of his trophy
Reader 5	Sam	Coach Lee's young son

PART 1: The Gym

Reader 1 (Narrator): *(happily)* It was Friday morning at Green Hill Junior High. Tomorrow was the big basketball final, and the whole school was excited.

Reader 3 (Ben): *(nervously, raising a hand)* Mia! Mia! Come quickly! Something terrible has happened!

Reader 2 (Mia): Slow down, Ben. Take a deep breath. What's wrong?

Reader 3 (Ben): *(nervously, looking around)* The trophy is gone! The gold trophy in the glass case. It's not there anymore!

Reader 2 (Mia): *(sadly)* Gone? But the final is tomorrow!

Reader 1 (Narrator): The two friends ran down the hall to the gym. Coach Lee was standing in front of the empty glass case.

Reader 4 (Coach Lee): *(angrily, pointing)* I can't believe this! Who would steal our trophy? We won that trophy three years in a row!

Reader 2 (Mia): Coach Lee, when did you last see it?

Reader 4 (Coach Lee): Last night, at about six o'clock. I locked the gym door myself.

Reader 2 (Mia): Was anything else missing?

Reader 4 (Coach Lee): *(sadly, shrugging)* No. Only the trophy. And the door was still locked this morning.

PART 2: Looking for Clues

Reader 1 (Narrator): Mia looked carefully around the gym. She was quiet for a long time.

Reader 3 (Ben): What are you looking for?

Reader 2 (Mia): *(pointing)* Clues, Ben. A thief always leaves something behind.

Reader 1 (Narrator): Under the seats, Mia found three small things: a white feather, a few pieces of popcorn, and a wet footprint.

Reader 3 (Ben): *(confused, shrugging)* A feather? Popcorn? That doesn't make any sense.

Reader 2 (Mia): Hmm. This footprint is very small. It's too small for an adult.

Reader 3 (Ben): *(nervously)* Maybe it was a ghost! People say the old gym is haunted!

Reader 2 (Mia): *(happily)* Ghosts don't eat popcorn, Ben.

PART 3: The Answer

Reader 1 (Narrator): *(nervously)* Just then, they heard a strange sound from the storage room. Squeak. Squeak. Squeak.

Reader 3 (Ben): *(nervously, shaking head)* Did you hear that? I'm not going in there!

Reader 2 (Mia): *(raising a hand)* Then I'll go first. Stay behind me.

Reader 1 (Narrator): Mia slowly opened the door. The room was dark. She turned on the light.

Reader 2 (Mia): *(happily, raising a hand)* Ben! Coach! Come and look!

Reader 1 (Narrator): *(happily)* Inside the storage room sat a little white duck. Next to the duck was the gold trophy, full of popcorn.

Reader 4 (Coach Lee): *(shrugging)* A duck? How did a duck get into my gym?

Reader 2 (Mia): *(pointing)* Look, the window above the door is open. The duck came in from the pond last night. It was looking for food.

Reader 3 (Ben): *(happily, thumbs up)* And the trophy was the perfect bowl!

Reader 4 (Coach Lee): But who put the popcorn in the trophy?

Reader 1 (Narrator): Everyone turned around. A small boy was standing at the door. It was Coach Lee's son, Sam.

Reader 5 (Sam): *(sadly)* I'm sorry, Dad. The duck was so hungry. I just wanted to help it.

Reader 4 (Coach Lee): *(gently)* Oh, Sam. You should have asked me first. But you have a kind heart.

PART 4: The Final

Reader 1 (Narrator): *(happily)* The next day, the trophy was back in the glass case, shiny and clean. And the team had a new friend.

Reader 3 (Ben): *(happily, raising a hand)* Ladies and gentlemen, please welcome... Lucky the Duck!

Reader 2 (Mia): *(gently)* Sometimes the biggest mystery has the smallest answer.

ALL READERS: *(happily, bowing)* Thank you!

— THE END —

Reading Tips

- Readers do not memorize: read from the script, but look up at the audience when you can.
- The words in *(italics)* are stage cues. Do not read them aloud; act them with your voice and face.
- Narrator sets the mood of each part. Characters react to each other, not to the paper.
- Pause briefly after each PART heading so the audience knows the scene has changed.